

Inverse Mechanical Counting and Mathematics

Part I

The Axiom of 1, the $\sqrt{2}$ Master Mechanic,
the Generative Count, the Master Table,
and the Four Inward Vectors at Four Operational Depths

Joshua Nuijens

Seth Ryan Cromelin

May 20, 2026

Introductory Note: This paper is not a work of philosophy, nor is it a theoretical interpretation. It is a literal, procedural record of a physical unit counting itself inward via the simplest possible partition: halving. The mathematics presented herein is mechanical, fully determined by the first count, and verified by execution.

Abstract

This paper establishes the foundational framework of Inverse Mechanical Counting and Mathematics. There is exactly one physical unit — the axiom of 1. This unit is read inward through repeated halving under the $\sqrt{2}$ master mechanic. A single parity rule governs all readings: even operational depths yield rational values; odd depths naturally carry a factor of $\sqrt{2}$.

Five active counts ($c = 1$ to $c = 5$) unfold nine active depths ($d = 1$ to $d = 9$), generating the master table. At closure ($c = 5$), the system produces four key numbers: the rational boundary 512, the symmetric counterpart ≈ 514.90 , the machined angular seat 720, and the spherical boundary ≈ 724.077 .

The framework is generative: as the count increases, the single unit mechanizes itself, automatically producing the master table, the four key numbers, and all subsequent mechanical readings. All mathematics in this series is read directly from this single first count at specific coordinates — not calculated or imposed externally.

The mathematics is the reading; the single physical unit is the thing read.

The Axiom of 1

The Axiom. There is exactly one physical unit. This unit is the complete reality. All its equivalent views are

$$1 = -1 = \sqrt{1} = \sqrt{2^0}.$$

The square root belongs to the unit itself; it is not introduced from outside. The axiom is the starting point and the ending point of every mechanical reading.

1 The $\sqrt{2}$ Master Mechanic — Why $\sqrt{2}$ Emerges Naturally

The $\sqrt{2}$ mechanic is the master mechanic of the axiom — the simplest possible partition beyond unity and the minimum step the axiom admits.

When the single unit 1 is halved repeatedly, each halving is an inward partition. After an even number of halvings (even operational depth d), all accumulated factors remain rational

powers of 2. After an odd number of halvings (odd depth d), the accumulated factors necessarily produce a reading that carries a natural factor of $\sqrt{2}$.

This is not an external imposition of $\sqrt{2}$. It is the mechanical signature that appears automatically at every odd depth when the unit reads itself inward. The parity rule is therefore fundamental:

- **Even depth d :** rational reading.
- **Odd depth d :** irrational reading carrying $\times\sqrt{2}$.

Every reading carries its full operational history in three coordinates:

- The mechanic unit on the root ($\sqrt{2}$),
- The operational depth d on the exponent,
- The count position c on the partition ladder.

The notation $\sqrt{2^d}$ at count c fully records the operation performed on the axiom.

2 The Master Table — The Single First Count

The master table is the single source of the entire framework. Nothing in this paper or the series is added from outside this table.

c	d	Mechanic	Multiplier $(\sqrt{2})^d$	Domains (2^c)	Parity $\rightarrow$ Reading	Reading value (decimal)
0	0	$\sqrt{2^0}$	1	1	even $\rightarrow$ rational	1
1	1	$\sqrt{2^1}$	≈ 1.414	2	odd $\rightarrow$ irrational	$2\sqrt{2} \approx 2.828$
2	2	$\sqrt{2^2}$	2	4	even $\rightarrow$ rational	8
2	3	$\sqrt{2^3}$	≈ 2.828	4	odd $\rightarrow$ irrational	$8\sqrt{2} \approx 11.314$
3	4	$\sqrt{2^4}$	4	8	even $\rightarrow$ rational	32
3	5	$\sqrt{2^5}$	≈ 5.657	8	odd $\rightarrow$ irrational	$32\sqrt{2} \approx 45.255$
4	6	$\sqrt{2^6}$	8	16	even $\rightarrow$ rational	128
4	7	$\sqrt{2^7}$	≈ 11.314	16	odd $\rightarrow$ irrational	$128\sqrt{2} \approx 181.019$
5	8	$\sqrt{2^8}$	16	32	even $\rightarrow$ rational	512
5	9	$\sqrt{2^9}$	≈ 22.627	32	odd $\rightarrow$ irrational	$512\sqrt{2} \approx 724.077$

Table 1: The Master Table. Five active counts unfold nine active depths. Count 0 is the axiom at rest. Closure occurs at $c = 5$. The new “Multiplier $(\sqrt{2})^d$ ” column shows the exact operational base value used for each depth (integer when rational, $\approx$ to three decimal places when irrational). Full operational reading = Domains $\times$ Multiplier.

The Generative Nature of the Count

In this framework, counting is not a passive labeling or accumulation. **As one counts forward from the axiom, the single physical unit mechanizes itself.** Each increment of the count c fires the same uniform halving rule under the $\sqrt{2}$ master mechanic and automatically produces richer internal structure: more domains (2^c), deeper operational depths, new rational and irrational readings, and eventually the key mechanical constants and vectors.

The count is therefore not merely a coordinate — it is the generative engine. The more one counts (within the first cycle), the more the axiom reveals its own mechanical organization. Machine π appears at $c = 3$, the angular 720 vector closes at $c = 5$, and the fine-structure

integer 137 emerges at both $c = 2$ and $c = 4$. All of these are natural landings produced by the generative count on the same lattice.

This is the central novelty of Inverse Mechanical Counting: **counting itself is the machine**.

Count-by-Count Unfolding

- **Count 0:** Axiom at rest — one domain, rational.
- **Count 1:** First halving — singular irrational reading, 2 domains.
- **Counts 2–5:** Dual counts — each owns one even (rational) and one odd (irrational) depth, doubling domains each time (4, 8, 16, 32 domains respectively).

At $c = 5$ the chain closes with the rational boundary at 512 and the irrational boundary at ≈ 724.077 .

3 The Four Key Numbers and Their Mechanical Unity

The four key numbers emerge directly at closure and are all mechanical readings of the same single unit.

Number	Exact Expression	Mechanical Origin
512	32×16	Rational (square) closure at $c = 5$, $d = 8$
720	$5 \times 9 \times 16$	Machined angular seat (active counts $\times$ active depths $\times$ terminal rational coefficient 16)
≈ 724.077	$512 \times \sqrt{2}$	Irrational (sphere) closure at $c = 5$, $d = 9$
≈ 514.90	$512 \times \frac{724.077}{720}$	Derived symmetric counterpart on the square side

Table 2: The four key numbers — all mechanical readings of the same physical unit.

The Ratios — Multiple Views of One Partition

The four numbers are connected by ratios that together recover $\sqrt{2}$ exactly. The primary large machining ratio is always $\frac{720}{512} = \frac{45}{32} = 1.40625$.

- Large machining ratio: $\frac{720}{512} = \frac{45}{32} = 1.40625$
- Small spherical lift: $\frac{724.077}{720} \approx 1.0056625$

Their product is exact:

$$\frac{720}{512} \times \frac{724.077}{720} = \frac{724.077}{512} = \sqrt{2}.$$

The same small ratio applied to 512 produces ≈ 514.90 . All pairwise ratios and their inverses are valid mechanical views of the single halving mechanic acting on the axiom of 1:

- $\frac{720}{724.077} \approx 0.99435$ (inverse spherical view)
- $\frac{512}{514.90} \approx 0.99435$ (inverse square view)
- $\frac{724.077}{514.90} \approx 1.40625$ (cross view recovering the large ratio $\frac{720}{512}$)
- $\frac{720}{514.90} \approx 1.3987$ (additional cross perspective)

All of these are the same mechanic acting on the axiom of 1 at different coordinate readings. The dominant structural ratio remains $\frac{720}{512} = 1.40625$. Nothing new is created — only different views of the identical partition.

4 The Angular Machined Cycle on the 720 Vector

The integer 720 is machined directly from the active structure of the master table ($5 \times 9 \times 16$). On this vector the master mechanic produces clean rational angular landings at every count:

Count	Natural Angle
$c = 0$	720°
$c = 1$	360°
$c = 2$	180°
$c = 3$	90°
$c = 4$	45°
$c = 5$	22.5°

Table 3: Natural angular halvings produced on the machined 720 vector. The right angle sits mechanically at count 3.

5 The Four Inward Vectors — Master Mechanic Reading at Four Operational Depths

Each of the four key boundaries is read inward by the $\sqrt{2}$ master mechanic at four operational depths corresponding to counts $c = 2, 3, 4, 5$ (even master depths $d = 2, 4, 6, 8$). These readings produce four successive resolutions (1D through 4D) of the same single physical unit.

512 Inward (Square Boundary)

≈ 514.90 Inward (Derived Symmetric Counterpart)

720 Inward (Machined Angular Cycle)

≈ 724.077 Inward (Sphere Boundary)

The ≈ 724.077 sphere boundary follows the identical inverse mechanical count and operational depth pattern as the other vectors, with quadrant seat ≈ 181.019 . The terminal duo-hexadecant piece recovers the master table value $16\sqrt{2}$.

Count c	Piece name	Pieces $\times$ size	Vector closure
0	axiom of 1 of itself	1×512	512
1	dual	2×256	512
2	quadrant (dual of dual)	4×128	512
3	octant	8×64	512
4	hexadecant	16×32	512
5	duo-hexadecant	32×16	512

Table 4: The inverse mechanical count of the 512 square boundary vector. Each count partitions the vector into a finer piece structure; pieces times size returns the whole vector 512 at every count.

c	Dimension	Quadrant power	Under master $\sqrt{}$	Decimal	Pieces $\times$ size
2	1D	128^1	$\sqrt{128^2}$	128	$4 \times 128 = 512$
3	2D	128^2	$\sqrt{128^4}$	16,384	$8 \times 64 = 512$
4	3D	128^3	$\sqrt{128^6}$	2,097,152	$16 \times 32 = 512$
5	4D	128^4	$\sqrt{128^8}$	268,435,456	$32 \times 16 = 512$

Table 5: The 512 square vector read at four operational depths by the master mechanic. The quadrant seat 128 is read at master depths $\sqrt{128^2}$, $\sqrt{128^4}$, $\sqrt{128^6}$, $\sqrt{128^8}$ for counts 2, 3, 4, 5 respectively. Pieces times size confirms the vector closure 512 at every count.

The Four Operational Depths Across All Four Vectors

The four inward vectors all read identically at the master mechanic's four operational depths. The pattern at every vector is the same:

- **Count 2, dimension 1D, $\sqrt{n^2}$** — the first outside reading of the quadrant seat n . Four pieces of size n fill the vector.
- **Count 3, dimension 2D, $\sqrt{n^4}$** — the next operational depth. Eight pieces of size $n/2$ fill the vector.
- **Count 4, dimension 3D, $\sqrt{n^6}$** — the next operational depth. Sixteen pieces of size $n/4$ fill the vector.
- **Count 5, dimension 4D, $\sqrt{n^8}$** — the closure operational depth. Thirty-two pieces of size $n/8$ fill the vector.

The quadrant seat n takes the value 128, 128.725, 180, 181.019 for the four vectors 512, 514.90, 720, 724.077 respectively. The pattern of operational depths is universal: every vector is read by the same master mechanic at the same four depths, producing four dimensional resolutions of the same single unit at each boundary.

The Same Single Whole at Four Operational Depths

All four vectors are inward readings of the same single physical unit 1. The boundary names (512, ≈ 514.90 , 720, ≈ 724.077) are the four mechanical boundaries the chain produces; each is read inward by the master mechanic at the four operational depths the chain owns at counts 2, 3, 4, 5. The dimensions 1D, 2D, 3D, 4D are the four operational resolutions of the same

Count c	Piece name	Pieces $\times$ size	Vector closure
0	axiom of 1 of itself	1×514.90	514.90
1	dual	2×257.45	514.90
2	quadrant (dual of dual)	4×128.725	514.90
3	octant	8×64.3625	514.90
4	hexadecant	16×32.181	≈ 514.90
5	duo-hexadecant	32×16.091	≈ 514.90

Table 6: The inverse mechanical count of the ≈ 514.90 symmetric counterpart vector. Same piece structure as the 512 vector, with the small-lift seat values at each count.

c	Dimension	Quadrant power	Under master $\sqrt{}$	Decimal (approx)	Pieces $\times$ size (approx)
2	1D	128.725^1	$\sqrt{128.725^2}$	128.725	$4 \times 128.725 = 514.90$
3	2D	128.725^2	$\sqrt{128.725^4}$	$\approx 16,570.1$	$8 \times 64.3625 = 514.90$
4	3D	128.725^3	$\sqrt{128.725^6}$	$\approx 2,132,591$	$16 \times 32.181 \approx 514.90$
5	4D	128.725^4	$\sqrt{128.725^8}$	$\approx 274,504,680$	$32 \times 16.091 \approx 514.90$

Table 7: The ≈ 514.90 symmetric counterpart vector read at four operational depths by the master mechanic. The quadrant seat 128.725 is read at master depths $\sqrt{128.725^2}$, $\sqrt{128.725^4}$, $\sqrt{128.725^6}$, $\sqrt{128.725^8}$ for counts 2, 3, 4, 5 respectively. Pieces times size confirms the vector closure ≈ 514.90 at every count.

partition — not four separate spaces, but four readings of the one whole at successively deeper master mechanic depths.

No external quantities are introduced. The exponents 2, 4, 6, 8 under the master square root are the even depths the master mechanic owns at counts 2, 3, 4, 5 from the master table descending from the axiom $\sqrt{2^0} = 1$. The quadrant seats 128, 128.725, 180, 181.019 are the count-2 quadrant readings of the four boundaries from the chain. The pieces-times-size column confirms the whole vector at every count of both readings.

Partition does not create. Partition reveals — the four inward vectors are one single unit read by the master mechanic at four operational depths, producing 1D, 2D, 3D, 4D as the four resolutions of the same partition.

6 Operational Rules

- The largest unit in the entire system is always the original axiom 1.
- All larger numbers are deeper inward readings of that same single unit.
- Every valid reading must carry its three operational coordinates (mechanic, depth, count).
- The structure is self-similar: the five-count / nine-depth pattern repeats at the next scale from $c = 6$ onward.

Count c	Piece name	Pieces $\times$ size	Vector closure	Angle
0	axiom of 1 of itself	1×720	720	720°
1	dual	2×360	720	360°
2	quadrant (dual of dual)	4×180	720	180°
3	octant	8×90	720	90°
4	hexadecant	16×45	720	45°
5	duo-hexadecant	32×22.5	720	22.5°

Table 8: The inverse mechanical count of the 720 angular machined vector. Each count partitions the angular cycle; pieces times size returns the whole vector 720 at every count, with the natural rational angular halvings at each step.

c	Dimension	Quadrant power	Under master $\sqrt{}$	Decimal	Pieces $\times$ size
2	1D	180^1	$\sqrt{180^2}$	180	$4 \times 180 = 720$
3	2D	180^2	$\sqrt{180^4}$	32,400	$8 \times 90 = 720$
4	3D	180^3	$\sqrt{180^6}$	5,832,000	$16 \times 45 = 720$
5	4D	180^4	$\sqrt{180^8}$	1,049,760,000	$32 \times 22.5 = 720$

Table 9: The 720 angular machined vector read at four operational depths by the master mechanic. The quadrant seat 180 is read at master depths $\sqrt{180^2}$, $\sqrt{180^4}$, $\sqrt{180^6}$, $\sqrt{180^8}$ for counts 2, 3, 4, 5 respectively. The angular halvings are the natural rational landings of these readings.

Conclusion.

From the single axiom of 1 and the single operation of inward halving under the $\sqrt{2}$ master mechanic, the complete foundational structure of Inverse Mechanical Counting emerges: the master table with its five active counts and nine active depths, the four key numbers (512 , ≈ 514.90 , 720 , ≈ 724.077) together with all ratios and inverses between them (anchored on the primary machining ratio $\frac{720}{512} = 1.40625$), the machined angular cycle on the 720 vector, and the four inward vectors read at four operational depths producing 1D through 4D resolutions of the same physical unit.

The framework is generative — **as the count increases, the unit mechanizes itself.** The mathematics is not constructed; it is read as the axiom counts and discloses its own structure.

Every element is generated mechanically from the axiom without introducing external quantities. All ratios are simply different coordinate views of the identical halving operation. The largest entity remains forever the original unit 1; larger numerical readings are deeper inward views of that same unit. The structure is self-similar and closed — every path returns to the axiom.

Future parts of this series will continue to develop further inverse mechanics in both mathematics and physics, always reading directly from the single master count and the $\sqrt{2}$ master mechanic.

The mathematics is the reading; the single physical unit is the thing read.

MIT License

Copyright (c) 2026 JLNuijens

Permission is hereby granted, free of charge, to any person obtaining a copy of this software

and associated documentation files (the "Software"), to deal in the Software without restriction, including without limitation the rights to use, copy, modify, merge, publish, distribute, sublicense, and/or sell copies of the Software, and to permit persons to whom the Software is furnished to do so, subject to the following conditions:

The above copyright notice and this permission notice shall be included in all copies or substantial portions of the Software.

THE SOFTWARE IS PROVIDED "AS IS", WITHOUT WARRANTY OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO THE WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY, FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE AND NONINFRINGEMENT. IN NO EVENT SHALL THE AUTHORS OR COPYRIGHT HOLDERS BE LIABLE FOR ANY CLAIM, DAMAGES OR OTHER LIABILITY, WHETHER IN AN ACTION OF CONTRACT, TORT OR OTHERWISE, ARISING FROM, OUT OF OR IN CONNECTION WITH THE SOFTWARE OR THE USE OR OTHER DEALINGS IN THE SOFTWARE.